



Figure 4: Selecting the compiler



Figure 5: A game of Tetris in Code::Blocks

Default code

One very nice feature that I like in Code::Blocks is the 'Default Code'. I am always irritated by the fact that whenever I have to code, I have to type all those `#includes`, `int main()`, etc. Fortunately, this particular feature in Code::Blocks allows you to set a default code that will be present in every new file you create. This feature is useful not just to hobbyists like me but also to professional coders. Sometimes a company's coding policy may require sources to have a standard design with author name, date, etc. This predefined content is called default code. This setting can be selected under 'Settings -> Editor - Default Code'.

The default 'Hello world' program in our first example is actually the default code; you can modify it and add anything you want there.

Bored with coding?

No matter how passionate you are about coding, after a point, when you are stuck with your code and feel nothing works, it's quite natural to get irritated. That's when Code::Blocks can even help you relax by providing some entertainment. The classic games of Snake and Tetris are available from the 'Plugins -> BYO Games' menu. In order to ensure that you only spend a limited time on recreation, there is an option to set the amount of time for which you are allowed to play, which is available in the 'Environment -> Settings' menu.

I have briefly touched on some of the features of Code::Blocks that might be useful to programmers, but this is not where it ends. Code::Blocks has many more plug-ins and features, like 'Auto versioning', where it generates the version number, and a 'todolist plugin'. It also supports a wide variety of compilers and can improve the efficiency of your coding skills. Hope this article will be helpful to at least some coders out there, who are not familiar with Code::Blocks. **END** 

References

- [1] <http://www.codeblocks.org/>
- [2] <http://www.codeblocks.org/>
- [3] <http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Code::Blocks>
- [4] http://www.codeblocks.org/docs/main_codeblocks_en.html

By: Vineeth Kartha

The author, who is an electrical and electronics engineer, has a great passion for open source technologies, computer programming and electronics. When not coding, the author loves to do glass paintings. He can be reached at vineethkartha@ieee.org or at <http://www.thebeautifulmind.com>



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